Log Management Fundamentals

01 Introduction

The Log Management Fundamentals exam is intended for individuals who can effectively demonstrate an overall knowledge of Datadog's Log Management product, independent of a specific job role.

This exam will test and validate knowledge on the following topics:

- Understand logging
  - systems
  - formats
  - emission
- Understand log collection in Datadog
- Understand and use log parsing and associated rules
- Understand how to search and filter logs
- Understand how to use logs for Analysis in troubleshooting

Refer to the **Content outline** below for a full list of topics covered by this exam. This is a pilot exam with a maximum seat time of 2 hours.

02 Target Candidates

Ideal candidates have at least 6 months of experience using the Datadog Log Management product and associated features. Candidates will demonstrate an understanding of how Log Management works and how it is best used in production.

This certification is intended for professionals in roles such as:

- Site Reliability Engineer
- DevOps Engineer
- Cloud/Infrastructure Engineer
- Application Support Engineer
- Security engineer
- Software engineer
- Engineering manager
- Platform/Observability engineers
- Compliance/Audit teams

Note that while certain professional roles may align closely with the exam content, the certification is open to candidates from all professional backgrounds.

RECOMMENDED DATADOG KNOWLEDGE

A target candidate should have substantial knowledge about the following:

- Logging Fundamentals
- Log Collection
- Log Parsing
- Log Searching & Filtering
- Log Analysis
- Log Utilization
- Log Troubleshooting

03 Out of Scope

The following is a list (non-exhaustive) of topics that are out of scope for the exam:

- Programming
- Systems Architecture
- Testing
- Cross-product Applications of Logs
- Observability Pipelines

04 Exam Content and Outline

QUESTION TYPE

The exam only contains one type of question:

- **Multiple choice**: Has one correct response and two or more incorrect responses (distractors)

Select the response that most accurately answers the question. Incorrect options, or distractors, are designed to appear plausible within the context of the question. Any unanswered questions will be scored as incorrect.

NUMBER OF QUESTIONS

The exam includes a total of 90 multiple-choice questions. 75 questions are scored and will count toward your final score.

PRE TEST ITEMS

The exam includes 15 pre-test (unscored) questions that do not affect your score. Datadog collects information about candidate performance on pretest questions to evaluate them for future use on exam forms. Pretest questions are not identified to the candidate on the exam.

CONTENT OUTLINE

The exam content outline includes the knowledge domains and related subdomains of content on the exam.

Logging Fundamentals
Logging Systems – Rationale & Justification
Logging Formats
Log Emission
Log Collection
Enabling Log Collection
Log Filtering & Obfuscation

Log Collection
Processors & Pipelines
Standard Attributes
Log Searching & Filtering
Live vs. Explorer
Search Syntax
Explorer Functionality
Log Analysis
Filtering and Excluding
Aggregations
Visualizing
Log Utilization
Monitors & Alerting
Metric Generation
Exporting
Log Troubleshooting
Ingestion Issues

05

Study and Preparation

It is expected that you will have done some preparation for the exam. This preparation should include using the platform, but it can also include taking Datadog's recommended courses and reading relevant documentation. To help you get started, we recommend the following list of learning materials.

LOG MANAGEMENT FUNDAMENTALS CERTIFICATION LEARNING PATH

A series of 16 courses designed to help you prepare for the Log Management Fundamentals Certification Exam by covering key exam topics. Please note that completing the learning path does not guarantee a passing score on the Exam.

PRACTICE EXAM

A 25-question practice exam designed to demonstrate overall knowledge of Datadog's Log Management, independent of any specific job role, as you prepare for the full certification exam. You can take it anytime, at your own pace, completely free of charge.

DOCUMENTATION

We've pulled together a handful of documentation links that candidates might otherwise overlook. Exploring these materials can add depth to your preparation and help clarify topics that may appear on the exam.

- Log Management
- Host Agent Log Collection
- Agent Configuration Files
- Getting Started with Tags

DATADOG FOUNDATIONAL ENABLEMENT TECHNICAL TRAINING

A list of instructor-led Datadog training sessions designed to build a foundational understanding of the Datadog platform. Concise 60-minute sessions with practical demonstrations.

- Foundation Enablement: Log Management
- Foundation Enablement: Intermediate Log Management
- Foundation Enablement: Introduction to Monitors
- Foundation Enablement: Tagging

Please note that completing the learning paths, courses, or reviewing the documentation **does not** guarantee a passing score on the exam.